

L008 Practice Sheet — Medical English: SBAR Patient Handover

This worksheet is for English language education purposes only. It does not constitute medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

SECTION 1 — Core Vocabulary

Word / Phrase	Part of Speech	Definition	Example Sentence
Handover	Noun	Transfer of patient care between shifts	I'll give you the handover for bed 4 now.
Admitted with	Verb Phrase	Primary reason patient was brought in	He was admitted with severe chest pain.
Observations	Noun	Patient's vital signs	Her observations are stable this morning.
Deteriorating	Verb	Getting worse	The patient's condition is deteriorating rapidly.
Nil by mouth	Adj. Phrase	Must not eat or drink anything	He is nil by mouth until after the surgery.
Discharge plan	Noun	Plan for care after leaving hospital	We need to discuss the discharge plan.
On-call	Adjective	Available for emergencies	The on-call doctor has been notified.
Review	Verb/Noun	Examine a patient again	The consultant will review him this afternoon.

SECTION 2 — The SBAR Framework

Letter	Stands For	What to Say	Example Phrase
S	Situation	State who you are calling about and why	I am calling about [patient] in bed [N].
B	Background	Give the admission reason and history	He/She was admitted with [reason].
A	Assessment	Report current observations/condition	His/Her observations are [stable/deteriorating].
R	Recommendation	State what action you are requesting	I recommend [doctor] review him/her [urgency].

SECTION 3 — Fill in the Blanks

Complete the SBAR handover using the words from the box below. Each word is used once.

[admitted with deteriorating nil by mouth observations review on-call handover
discharge plan]

- I am calling to give you the _____ for Mrs. Ahmed in bed 12.
- She was _____ a suspected urinary tract infection.
- Her _____ have been stable, but she is now running a temperature.
- I am concerned her condition is _____ — she seems more confused.
- She is _____ as she is scheduled for a procedure tomorrow.
- I would like the _____ doctor to _____ her tonight.

7. We also need to finalise her _____ before she can go home.

Answer Key: 1. handover 2. admitted with 3. observations 4. deteriorating 5. nil by mouth 6. on-call / review 7. discharge plan

On Duty English — Job-specific English for the career you actually have. Free resources at <https://practice.oabuilds.io/practice/L008/>
| Lessons developed using AI-assisted production with reviewed industry vocabulary sources.